

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a website:

Podcasting

Podcasting has become an effective and popular way to share exciting stories, meaningful conversations and valuable information. Due to their growing popularity, podcasts have become a part of our daily lives. But what is podcasting and why is it so popular?

A podcast is an audio program that is available for streaming or downloading on the Internet. It is a series of episodes, often focusing on a specific topic, that listeners can subscribe to and enjoy whenever they want. Unlike other media, podcasts offer a more personal and intimate experience, allowing listeners to choose what they want to hear and when they want to hear it.

Listening to a podcast often feels like a conversation with a friend. Hosts and guests share personal stories, experiences and insights, creating a real connection with the audience. The world of podcasting is also diverse, with thousands of podcasts covering a wide range of genres and topics. The listener can discover new voices, perspectives and stories that would otherwise remain hidden.

Here are three types of podcast which are very popular:

News 	Storytelling 	Conversation 
News podcasts aim to bring the latest and biggest news stories to their listeners every day. They tend to be short, five to ten-minutes in length.	Storytelling podcasts often have a theme, such as crime or ghost stories. They have proven to be quite popular! Such stories are often told within 20 minutes.	In conversational podcasts, a host invites people, sometimes famous, onto the show to have a casual chat. Podcasts of this nature are often more than an hour long.

The Tourism Board has invited students to promote Hong Kong to international visitors through podcasts. Your group is meeting to plan a series of podcasts. You may want to talk about:

- which type of podcast can best promote Hong Kong
- what to include in the podcasts
- how to keep listeners interested in the series
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you listen to podcasts?
2. When do you listen to a podcast?
3. What do you like to listen to on a podcast?
4. Do you think making a podcast would be fun?
5. If you created a podcast, what would you talk about?
6. Are podcasts a good way to learn about a place?
7. Why do some people prefer videos over podcasts?
8. What skills should a podcast host have?